

- She can pursue artistic ambitions without the burden of EMIs or other setbacks

On the other hand, if she is saddled with student loans:

- She starts work-life with the aim to save every penny and job security is paramount
- If her friends plan a big foreign vacation, she must turn down so that she can quickly repay the loans
- In case you fall sick or need help in old age, leaving her job to come visit you is highly impossible.

Comparing the two outcomes, I'd give up buying a car or a home so that the kid goes to college without a worry. I'm a big fan of letting people have their freedom over decisions and the biggest decision of a person's life, post-graduation, should not be decided because of money. For that reason, I consider investing for child's college to be one of my top goals.

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Juggling all these priorities from the onset is not possible. Moreover, this kind of complexity often leads to inaction. In investing jargon, *'time wasted due to inaction is like sitting on a gold-mine but waiting for a shovel'*. You can start dirty by digging with your hands and focus on just one goal: retirement. As you plod through, you can acquire the tools and balance various priorities.

Personal finance writers believe 10% of your income is a good amount for investments. Again, if you figure you'd give more importance to future goals over current expenses, you can buck the trend. In fact, you can make investing as much as 30% of your monthly paycheck, as I've often done in conducive times.